



MONTHLY UPDATE

Cybersecurity: monthly update, August 2026

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32 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

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Algeria

The cybersecurity record this window is a warning about the state's own brand rather than about its systems. The Algiers wilaya [told citizens that unlicensed platforms are impersonating its institutions and public enterprises, mostly as fake e-ticketing storefronts built to harvest bank card details and personal data, and directed them to check the domain name before paying and to use only officially approved portals](#). It is a communique, not an enforcement action: no takedown, prosecution or count of impersonating sites is on record. The exposure it describes tracks the payment figures in the section below — more web merchants and more card use give a counterfeit storefront more to imitate.

Angola

The incumbent operator's mobile voice, data and internet services failed nationwide from 02:20 on 28 July, affecting more than twenty million customers; fixed fibre and fixed-wireless stayed up throughout, so the failure was confined to the mobile layer. The network itself came back over four days — localised from 11:45 on 29 July, full second- and third-generation national coverage at about 23:00 on 30 July, and [messaging and electronic airtime sales back on 31 July](#). The services running on it took nine: the operator dates [voice, messaging, mobile data, internet access and the third-party services carried over its network to 5 August](#), and gives the same close in [its own market update](#). Four days in, [card terminals were unreliable in Luanda shops and at filling stations and citizens were queueing at the ATMs for cash](#); a week in, [the cardless payment app was still unusable and Luanda bank branches were queueing one to two hours](#). No attribution, access vector or scope of data loss is established.

The aftermath produced the first public pressure for rules rather than repair: customers and security practitioners [called for mandatory incident-reporting obligations and a national computer security incident response team](#), small businesses describing lost sales and failed card payments across the disruption. Angola has neither: the base holds no CSIRT and no reporting duty, and the critical national infrastructure designation that would carry one is itself *Not held*.

The Executive's first answer to the National Assembly on critical-infrastructure risk, given on 31 July, was the standing build programme — the national data centre and the country-code domain — with no new measure, obligation or timetable announced. Telecommunications remains undesignated as critical national infrastructure, and named analysts argued during the month that it should be designated alongside power and water.

A regional preparatory meeting on radiocommunications opened in Luanda on 3 August, seven days into the outage and two before it closed, with the resilience of telecommunications infrastructure on its agenda.

Check Point Research's July telemetry [puts Angolan organisations at 5,714 attacks a week against an African average of 3,237](#), the highest of the four African markets it broke out — the vendor's installed base, not a national measurement.

Benin

The month's one figure for how exposed the country is came from a vendor rather than the state. In a national newspaper interview the head of the computer emergency response body [cited 631 ransomware threats detected in Benin in 2024, on security-vendor telemetry reported through Interpol's Africa assessment](#), attributing the rise to fast adoption outrunning security practice and to a criminal market where access and tooling can be rented rather than built. How much of the national estate that vendor sees is unpublished, so the count is not a measure of national exposure, and no incident, ransom-payment or recovery figure stands beside it.

Botswana

A published account documents a [growing digital safety problem](#). It is journalistic and carries no measure: no incident count, reporting route or response instrument accompanies it, which is what the record can and cannot say.

Burkina Faso

The Council of Ministers of 30 July [adopted two decrees applying the 2024 information-systems security law](#): one identifying, classifying and setting obligations for critical-infrastructure bodies, expressly spanning energy, water, health, telecommunications and finance, and one fixing periodic security audits and vesting auditor accreditation in the national cyberspace control body. The law had asserted both duties since July 2024 with no machinery attached.

The building meant to carry the supervision got its first progress statement in seven months. The digital transition minister [inspected the site on 5 August](#), where the technical managers put physical execution across that worksite and the first citizen service centre together at about 20%; the account names the build the Centre d'opération du Réseau Backbone national and gives it the same supervisory function the January account gave the supervision centre. The stated delivery month is October 2026.

Alongside the build, the state published a count of what it has tested. [205 state digital platforms have been put through security testing to find and correct vulnerabilities, 1,460 platforms on the .bf domain reachable from the internet have been mapped, and 28 public bodies placed under reinforced protection](#), all under the national critical-infrastructure programme. No period, finding, remediation rate or list of the bodies covered accompanies the figures.

Cameroon

The month produced the base's first measure of what cybercrime costs an individual here. A comparative study puts the [average loss per online job scam at 132,000 FCFA for Cameroonian victims, against 58,000 FCFA in Chad](#), and finds 82% of the Cameroonian cases to be WhatsApp-based social engineering linked to Nigerian networks, where the Chadian pattern is more localised SMS and voice phishing. It is a survey of respondents rather than a reported-crime series, and no sample size or national loss total is carried in the record held.

Cape Verde

The surveillance programme moved to a third phase on foreign money. China [made about EUR 9.3m available as non-reimbursable assistance for phase three of the Cidade Segura project](#), the implementation agreement signed in the week to 15 August by the interior minister and the Chinese ambassador at the National Police Command Centre in Praia, and stated as reinforcing the technological and operational capacity of the security forces and supporting criminal investigation. [Phase three covers command centres, data centres and wireless base stations at Assomada, Tarrafal de Santiago and Porto Novo, and expanded video surveillance in Praia and Mindelo](#). No camera count, retention rule, data-protection authorisation or oversight arrangement is published for this phase or the two before it.

Chad

The window's one cyber measure is a loss figure, and it comes from research rather than from the state. A comparative study of online job scams [puts the average loss for a Chadian victim at 58,000 FCFA per incident, against 132,000 FCFA in Cameroon](#), and finds the Chadian cases to be predominantly localised SMS and voice phishing — 70% of respondents — where the Cameroonian pattern is WhatsApp-based social engineering linked to Nigerian networks. It is a survey of respondents rather than a reported-crime series, and neither a sample size nor a national loss total is carried in the record held. Chad has no computer emergency response team and no adopted cybersecurity strategy, so there is nothing on the state's side of this to compare it against.

Congo

It [launched an open international tender on 23 July for a 24-month mission to draft the national cybersecurity strategy, a national training plan and national conferences](#), scope covering a sector diagnostic, a strategic roadmap and a standing forum; no contract value is published. On 28 July it [validated a consolidated draft setting qualification conditions for bodies authorised to audit information systems nationally](#), with no adoption instrument, publication date or entry into force stated. Its largest operational mandate arrived through tax legislation: a [decree of 31 March, published 9 July, puts the agency into joint homologation of every invoicing terminal, software and enterprise module](#); it awards the security label and conformity identifier, audits the infrastructure and takes [15% of homologation fees](#). The same roadmap also names a [national security operations centre and response team](#) among its infrastructure programmes; it does not exist either.

What the regulator does have is an enforcement record. It [dismantled a sixth SIM box fraud network of the year on 21 August in the Massengo district of Brazzaville, seizing two 16-port SIM boxes, a modem, a laptop and an automatic battery-recharging system, recovering 30 Ugandan numbers in fraudulent use and arresting two people, and puts that network's loss at about FCFA 42m over two months on more than 422,000 diverted call minutes](#). The estimate and the method behind it are the regulator's own, and no prosecution outcome is on record.

Cote d'Ivoire

The national cybersecurity agency [certified the country's first cohort of RGSSI information-security auditors and is opening two cybersecurity masters degrees](#) through its training centre, against a stated national shortfall of 2,000 cybersecurity professionals. Neither the cohort size nor the intake is given, so the gap can be stated and the progress against it cannot.

Gabon

The utility [restored billing and payment in Libreville and seven interior centres after the attack that took down 95% of its systems](#), describing its network on 4 August as healthy, secured and protected by reinforced measures, with restoration continuing elsewhere. The account is the company's own, the attackers are described as unidentified, and no forensic, criminal or damage-cost report is on file.

An audit that was signed in May reported in August. The state digital agency [delivered its information-systems audit findings to the health insurance fund on 12 August](#), three months after the two signed the memorandum, naming human resources, data and infrastructure as the three pillars of the fund's technology roadmap. The findings themselves are not published, and no remediation plan, timetable or cost is stated.

Ghana

A community-media cyber capability project launched on 3 August, certifying community-radio journalists into a standing press corps.

The Cybersecurity Act's licensing regime produced its first published penalties. The Cyber Security Authority [fined the Office of the Registrar of Companies and Purpleline Solutions a combined GH¢360,000 for breaching the Act's licensing requirements](#) on 13 August — GH¢240,000 against the Registrar in two penalties of GH¢120,000 for engaging an unlicensed cybersecurity service provider, and GH¢120,000 against the provider for operating without a licence. One of the two penalised bodies is itself a state registry. Five days later the Authority [fined a Big Four firm's Ghana practice GH¢360,000 — three penalties of GH¢120,000 — for continuing to provide regulated cybersecurity services, including to owners of critical information infrastructure, after three directives to obtain a licence](#), ordering it to cease and desist, governance, risk and compliance work included. The base holds no published penalty under the Act before 13 August, so both actions fall inside six days, and the Authority states it will name unlicensed providers publicly as an enforcement measure. Neither of the two largest penalties survived the week as announced. The firm's fine was declared [satisfactorily resolved in a joint statement issued the same day](#), which does not state whether it was paid, reduced or withdrawn; and the Registrar [rejected its own sanction as premature and procedurally unfair, dating a finance-ministry commitment authorisation to 28 November 2025 and its tender to 4 December, before the directive it is said to have breached](#). A regime whose first week of enforcement produces one settlement without terms and one contested timeline has published a gross figure, not a collected one.

The regulator also [held a two-day consultative and validation workshop with UNICEF Ghana on online child sexual exploitation and abuse](#), reviewing the national response and naming coordination and frontline-capacity gaps; no instrument or programme follows from it on the record.

It started teaching. A session at Accra on 19 August [put newsroom devices to journalists as deliberate targets rather than accidental victims, citing an Angolan journalist's 2024 spyware infection as the regional precedent](#). No count of journalists trained under the project has been published.

Kenya

The presidency's website was [defaced on 18 July with a 5 BTC ransom demand and restored on 20 July](#) — the second compromise of that portal in eight months. State House says no evidence of data access was found; cause and attribution are undisclosed.

A vendor threat report published on 13 August put the exposure at the ordinary end rather than the novel one: [malicious email attachments dominated, 46.2% of them scripts, quick-response-code phishing rose 145% between the second half of 2025 and the first of 2026, exploitation of a 2017 Office vulnerability more than doubled, and one loader became the country's fourth most-detected malware family](#). The figures are the vendor's own detections, not a national incident series.

The instrument establishing the new agency also reached the base this month, three months after it took effect. The [State Corporations \(National Cybersecurity Agency\) Order, 2026 — Legal Notice 89 of 2026, gazetted and commenced on 15 May 2026](#) — makes it an autonomous body corporate headquartered in Nairobi City County under the direction of the Cabinet Secretary for internal security, charged with formulating national cybersecurity strategy, auditing and certifying the resilience of designated critical information infrastructure, running the National Cybersecurity Operations Centre and maintaining a Cybersecurity Centre of Excellence, with a board seating the internal-security, Treasury and ICT principal secretaries alongside one academic and one private-sector appointee. Nothing in the record shows it exercising any of those powers yet. Leadership was named in the same month: an inaugural non-executive chair was announced and the President [appointed a director to lead it](#). No budget line, staff complement or first published function is on file, and the National Cybersecurity Policy beside it is still only planned.

Lesotho

The [interim Lesotho National Computer Security Incident Response Team](#) and the inaugural National Cybersecurity Forum were launched in Maseru on 29 July 2026. The forum is described by the Lesotho Communications Authority as a standing collaboration across government, industry, regulators, financial institutions and telecommunications providers. The response team is thus operating ahead of its enabling statute — the Cybercrime and Cybersecurity Bills it would sit under remain before the National Assembly — and on no published timetable. The ministry also reported a first Chief Information Security Officer appointed across government and a national Security Operations Centre being stood up.

Liberia

The Cybercrime Act 2025 [was signed into force by the President on 19 August 2026](#), ending a wait that ran from the Senate's concurrence through most of this year. The full text the base holds is still the 2021 base bill, which carries none of the 2025 provisions, so the Act is on record as in force and not as read.

Libya

The central bank [isolated its systems in June and a sample of bank data was later published on a dark-web site](#). No attribution, forensic account, scope of loss or restoration statement is held.

The interior ministry answered with an agreement rather than an instrument. It [signed a technical cooperation agreement with the national telecommunications company on 12 August](#) covering digital transformation, cybersecurity and telecommunications infrastructure, including shared platforms, installation of towers and equipment at ministry sites, and technical support. No value, duration or delivery date is published.

Malawi

The month's cybersecurity item is a loss rather than a control. The state oil company [was defrauded of K700m after attackers hijacked email from its Mozambican fuel-handling contractor and supplied false banking details, instructing its bank on 29 April 2026 to wire US\\$403,605 to a fraudulent account](#); the fraud surfaced two weeks later when the genuine contractor demanded payment, and was confirmed publicly on 24 August 2026. The company attributes the control weaknesses to the government-to-government fuel procurement model being introduced before operational and cybersecurity procedures were in place. No regulator finding, prosecution or recovery is on file.

Mauritius

Two cyber measures moved. The [July omnibus would empower the central bank to establish a cyber threat intelligence sharing platform](#) and to require financial institutions, and others it specifies, to participate — the clearest instance of mandatory threat-intelligence sharing in primary legislation on this record. At a [workshop on 29 July](#) the postal operator began being wired into the Universal Postal Union's global postal threat-sharing centre, with the ICT minister naming ISO/IEC 27001 as the standard he wants adopted.

August supplied the first figure for what any of this is against: [more than 4,000 reported cyber incidents in Mauritius since January 2026](#), given at the launch of the schools awareness programme. No reporting body, definition or comparable earlier period is named with it.

The ministry's own communique put [4,076 cybersecurity and online-behaviour reports between January and July 2026 against a cybercrime unit of seventeen investigators](#). Both figures come from the same communique, which is what makes the ratio quotable.

The instrument behind the blocking figures is now held, and it settles how they are counted. [Telecommunication Directive 2 of 2025, issued on 24 March 2025 under the ICT Act, moved the four internet service licence holders off the regulator's centralised child-sexual-abuse filter and onto on-premises filtering in each operator's own network against the Project Arachnid blacklist by 1 May 2025, with no deep packet inspection, HTTPS blocking only at domain level, monthly returns of access attempts and blocked addresses and domains, and an annual external security audit](#). The blocked-attempt totals the base carries are therefore hit counts against a list, not unique users and not confirmed retrievals.

Morocco

The [national cybersecurity strategy to 2030](#) is now held in full: four pillars — governance, cyberspace resilience, capacity development and regional cooperation — with 11 objectives, 26 initiatives and 60 actions, succeeding the first strategy of 2012. Its workforce commitments carry no numbers, and [a separate held source dates a national cybersecurity strategy to 2023 with US\\$100m earmarked and an agency created](#) — whether the two are the same instrument is not established.

The state answered the claim before the month ended. The national security and territorial surveillance directorates [categorically denied on 27 August any intrusion into their information systems or security databases, placing the published records instead in databases run by insurance companies and social and health cover bodies, and warning against doctored photographs and falsified documents circulating as security material](#). No insurer or cover body has answered, no regulator has ruled, and the provenance is therefore contested rather than established.

Against that architecture the month produced a claimed breach of the security services themselves. A hacker group said on 24 August that it had [published the personal data of 70,000 police and intelligence agents, a leak former members of the intelligence services judge at least partly authentic and which discloses details not previously public, including the date of birth of the head of the police and internal intelligence](#). Whether it is a new breach is contested: a Moroccan outlet calls it an assemblage of data already compromised in earlier hacks, and Moroccan media have covered it only marginally. The same group claimed the 2025 breach of the social security fund. No official confirmation, notification or investigation is on record, which is the part that bears on the strategy above rather than the claim itself.

Mozambique

The national response team put a number on what it is seeing. It [reported ransomware infection attempts detected on the national network and told organisations not to pay ransoms but to report them](#). It is the first such count the base holds; no period, sector breakdown or successful-infection figure accompanies it.

Namibia

The trust layer beneath the September electronic identity launch was signed in the last week of the month. The communications regulator and a German identity vendor [signed an implementation agreement with the home affairs ministry connecting it to the regulator's national trust framework](#), with the regulator as national root certification authority and the ministry becoming the first certification service provider through the issue of electronic identity documents. It is the first named certification service provider on this ledger, and it arrives a fortnight before the credential it is meant to certify.

Nigeria

The communications regulator [issued a Guidance Note on cybersecurity budgets on 7 August](#) under a framework effective since 23 February, adding a dedicated budget line with tracked spend and periodic audit, requiring a Chief Information Security Officer, and restating two-year in-country retention of call logs and traffic data; the compliance clock ends 23 February 2027. Two further bodies are announced and no more: [a Ministerial Advisory Council on Cybersecurity](#) with no membership or terms of reference published, and [a Payment Security Operations Centre](#) set as a 2028 target with no legal basis, funding line or operator named. Where staffing did move it moved on a foreign programme: the national cybersecurity coordinator [put a United Kingdom-funded bilateral partnership at more than 90 per cent implemented on 22 August, crediting it with the continent's first four SIM3-certified incident-response auditors at the national coordination centre, a reviewed national incident response plan and maturity frameworks for critical national information infrastructure](#). The completion figure is his own, and neither the memorandum nor the programme document is held.

Senegal

The institutions arrived after the attacks. The critical-infrastructure bill [provides for a national computer emergency response team the country does not yet have](#), and the Prime Minister [announced parliamentary hearings following recent attacks on state systems](#); no system, breach count or data loss is named in the announcement.

Procurement is the state's own diagnosis of the blockage, and it moved by memorandum: a [foreign cybersecurity supplier is reported seeking Senegalese partners](#), with no contract, value or scope stated. The offence figures the case for all this rests on moved barely at all: national police recorded [3,794 cybercrime offences in 2025 against 3,902 in 2024](#), reported alongside an international police organisation's estimate of at least US\$5bn in Africa-wide losses over the same year. Neither the recording basis nor a clear-up rate is stated.

Sierra Leone

The telecoms regulator ran two public-facing cyber messages in nine days. It [set out a consumer education campaign on online fraud on 28 July](#), stating that the fraudulent links circulating did not originate from the mobile networks and placing the burden on the consumer; on 30 July it [confirmed it was coordinating a response to ongoing cybersecurity incidents affecting digital services](#), naming no affected service, no attribution and no incident count.

The first tool rather than message came from an operator, not the state. On 18 August a mobile operator [launched a scam-alert channel for suspected fraud against its mobile-money service, reached on a *505# short code, an online form or a 111 call](#). It is one operator's own channel: no report volume, response time, remedy, referral route to the police or coordination with the regulator's response is published, and the Cyber Security and Crime Act 2021 still carries no reported prosecution.

The communications, technology and innovation ministry [published draft digital protection plans for four critical sectors](#); nothing is adopted and no implementation date is given. An original investigation [documented 27 WhatsApp account-takeover cases](#) and located the governance failure in the payout leg rather than in the platform "â€" which makes it a mobile-money supervision question rather than a platform one.

South Africa

The fraud series moved before the intrusion series did. The telecommunications industry body's sector report records [14,897 subscription fraud cases in the twelve months to April 2026, up 307% on the year before with every month above its counterpart](#), social engineering over messaging and calls having overtaken technical intrusion, AI-generated voices and messages used to carry it, and the sector described as in an active systemic-risk phase in which cyberattack, fraud, infrastructure crime, energy volatility and supply-chain disruption amplify one another. It is the body's own member case records rather than a police or regulator series.

Two independent readings of the year both point at the same thing. The financial regulator's fourth regulatory actions report records [140 public warnings and R2.89bn in penalties on 76 persons for the year to March](#), most warnings concerning unregistered providers promoting investment offerings on social media and about a fifth involving impersonation of licensed institutions, the regulator and its own staff among them. [Over R2bn of that total is a single deepfake-advertising matter](#), whose debarment and penalty reconsiderations were still pending at the report date. Separately a forensics firm puts [attacker dwell time at 18 days in 2025, with some intrusions running start to finish inside a day](#), attributed to ransomware-as-a-service and automated reconnaissance. It is one firm's caseload rather than a national series, and a shorter dwell time is faster execution, not better defence.

The state's answer to its own exposure is a training tender. The public service and administration department is [tendering to build a training programme for departmental information security officers across the public sector](#), to implement the directive on public service information security. No officer count, curriculum, budget or compliance deadline under that directive is stated.

Its own research estate showed what the exposure costs. The science minister told the National Assembly on 24 August that the late-May breach of the national supercomputer was caused by [vulnerabilities associated with the legacy high-performance computing system](#), with unauthorised access to parts of the environment and cryptocurrency mining malware deployed, and that [ageing components are technically constrained or no longer fully supported by their original vendors](#). A remediation and resilience programme covering access controls, privileged-access management, network segmentation, patch management and monitoring has since run, with forensic support and independent assurance from the council's own specialists. No cost, data-loss finding or outage duration is stated, and the account is the department's own — against the same centre having reached maximum capacity earlier in the month.

Sudan

The Council of Ministers reviewed a draft Cybersecurity Law on 6 August 2026, alongside draft Data and AI and Digital Transformation laws, and sent all three back for further study; no text has been published for any of them. A Sudanese delegation separately told an Arab-experts meeting in Tunis on 30 July that the country's cybercrime provisions are drafted to prevail over any conflicting law, reasoned on state sovereignty — a claim not yet reconciled with the draft law's own unsettled status.

Tanzania

One investigation put numbers on SIM-registration fraud: [198 SIM cards used in fraud were seized at Morogoro, 88 of them registered by a single agent under different names](#).

August gave the national series the earlier account lacked. The regulator told Parliament it had [blocked 39,117 fraud-linked phone numbers and 6,118 domains and applications in the 2025/26 financial year](#), removed 7,311 violating accounts and submitted 56 security-incident reports to the police; and it [identified 7,334 mobile lines linked to fraud between April and June 2026, down 25.3% from 9,817 in the preceding quarter](#), with two regions flagged as priorities and the regulator, operators and security agencies convening in August to coordinate further measures. Blocking is not prosecution: [56 incident reports stand against 39,117 numbers blocked](#), and no conviction or restitution figure is held.

The same budget statement [provides for cybercrime investigation centres at Dodoma and Zanzibar](#). Nothing is built, sited or staffed on the record, and the country still holds no published national cybersecurity strategy to place them in.

Togo

The cyber institutions are in place and the record of what they do is thin. [The national incident-response function runs inside a joint venture of the Togolese state and a Polish group](#), so the incident record, tooling and institutional memory sit with a foreign supplier; no incident-response profile or annual report is held. The agency's director-general put [more than 333,000 incidents handled between 2021 and 2024, rising from 39,168 to 181,088](#) — a 4.6-fold increase with no figure for 2022, 2023 or 2025 and no definition of an incident.

The team is at least visibly operating: it [issued a high-severity alert on an active online account-compromise campaign on 19 August](#). It is the first published alert the base holds from it, and no post-incident account, affected count or resolution follows.

Tunisia

The national cybersecurity agency [warned on 30 July 2026 of an SMS phishing campaign](#) built on fake unpaid-traffic-fine notices sent from foreign numbers, carrying links to counterfeit platforms that harvest banking and personal data. Its advice was to distrust unsolicited messages, and its offered test was that Tunisian government sites use only the national domain. The lure borrows the credibility of the state's own digitised payment channels; the response on record carries no takedown power and names no data-protection authority. A [second alert on 14 August](#) warned of a surge in social-media account takeovers worked through SMS and email verification-code social engineering.

The scale behind the alerts was published on 7 August: [57,430 cyberattacks recorded in the first half of 2025, and ransomware cases up 140% to 37,076 in 2024](#), on interior ministry and agency figures, as the government finalised a National Cybersecurity Strategy 2026-2030 aimed at critical-infrastructure resilience and skills. The two figures cover different periods and are not a series; no definition of a recorded attack and no incident-reporting obligation behind the count is stated.

Uganda

The ICT ministry [launched an updated national information security framework on 16 July](#), developed under the Uganda Digital Acceleration Project and setting minimum controls for government institutions, citing a 60% year-on-year rise in attacks including a UGX 62bn central-bank incident. The framework document itself is not published.

On 17 July the regulator opened work on a [national anti-piracy coordination framework](#) with broadcasters, three mobile operators, the revenue authority and the registration bureau. Legitimate pay-television subscriptions were [given as about 800,000 in March 2026 against about 1.65 million in 2021](#). Dynamic address and name-resolution blocking is under exploration, and participants at the convening raised the dual use of blocking infrastructure built for piracy.

Two accounts in August put the threat above the response. A continental police assessment [attributes over US\\$2m of losses to a single Ugandan deepfake investment scam](#), against 8% of intelligence analysts recorded as having advanced artificial-intelligence expertise and 94% of agencies as lacking digital forensics tools. At the communications regulator's first national cybersecurity conference on 13 August, an operator [called for fraud protection to be built into digital-finance products and described an interface letting banks check for recent SIM-swap activity before processing a transaction](#); no uptake figure for the interface is published. The central bank separately told a conference that [cybersecurity is now a national security issue](#).

The criminal investigations directorate [told a parliamentary committee inspection that its Crime Data Centre, originally due earlier, is now targeted for March 2027, that it will recruit internally to close an investigator shortage, and that it wants government and security databases integrated so detectives can link suspects, incidents and evidence quickly](#) - integration its director said would first require agreement on the legal and policy frameworks governing access.

Zambia

The Ministry of Information and Media declared the Cyber Crimes Act No. 4 of 2025 fully operational on 18 July 2026, warning that recording, publishing or distributing private communications without authorisation could bring prosecution and singling out public servants on confidential information. Compliance obligations were stated as extending to financial institutions, telecommunications operators, digital platforms, mobile money providers and e-commerce businesses ([enforcement account](#)). The declaration falls twenty-six days before the general election of 13 August. No prosecution, charge or conviction count has been published.

Three days earlier the cyber security agency had urged journalists to learn the cyber laws, framing them as protection for media houses against ransomware and disruption.

The regulator reported on 4 August that it had deactivated 43,500 SIM cards linked to mobile-money fraud and secured K19.8 million between January and June 2026, on consumer reports through a short code, with no breakdown by operator and no prior-period comparison ([regulator figures](#)).

Zimbabwe

The national incident response team is named in the ICT ministry's own priority projects and has no completion date or operating status attached. The international project record behind it [carries an empty status field and an achievements field still stating it will be updated on completion](#), for a project that ran from July 2017 to February 2021. What is new is the first-party statement: the [ministry lists establishment of the team among its seven priorities](#), aimed at monitoring, detecting and responding to cyber threats.

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